Relational database systems exist solely to facilitate working with sets of data that relate to each other. Within the database, relationships between different entities are represented by the presence of foreign keys. In figure 8.3, `Country` and `City` are related in a one-to-many relationship by the `CountryId` foreign key on the `City` table.

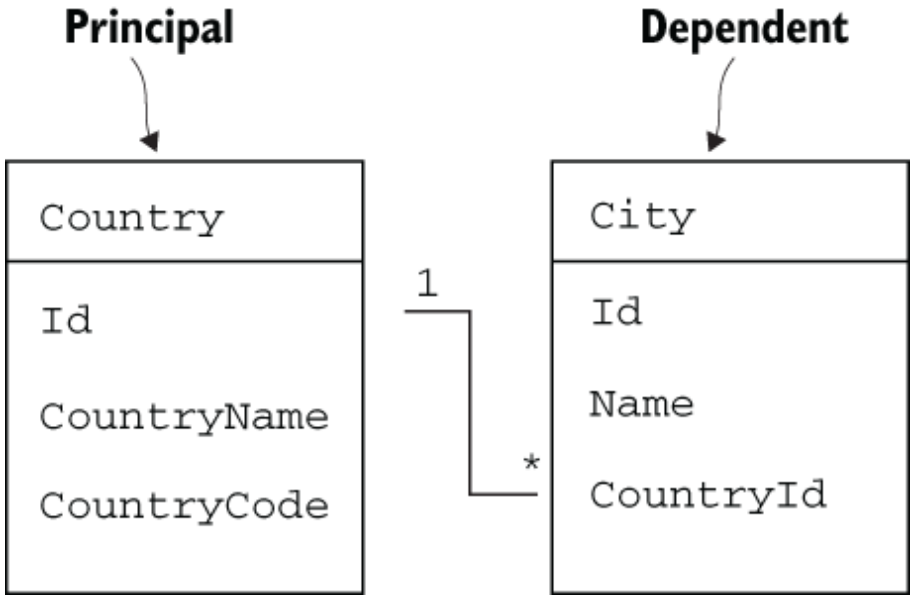


Figure 8.3 A one-to-many relationship exists between `Country` and `City`, where one country can have many cities.

By convention, relationships in an EF Core model are represented by *navigational properties*. These are properties in a class that cannot be mapped to a primitive or scalar value, such as a string, Boolean, integer, or `datetime` type. Your existing `City` class (see the next listing) already has a `Country` property that fits the description of a navigational property.

Listing 8.1 The `City` class with the `Country` navigational property

```
public class City
{
    public int Id { get; set; }
```